Intro Pivot Brief — Conversation First

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What happened

Apple won't take Intro as another dating app. Version 1.0 (55) was rejected on Sep 21 under Guideline 4.3(b) (spam in a saturated category) and 2.3 (metadata mentioned video calling). Resubmissions are now flagged for extended review. On Sep 25, reviewer Richard confirmed it directly: the dating category on the App Store is saturated.

The takeaway: small fixes won't get a dating app through. The next submission has to be a genuinely different product.

The opportunity

Conversation-first isn't a new direction. It's the identity we already wrote down. Our brainstorm framed Intro as an AI-guided self-discovery platform, with dating as the *first application* of a broader conversational system. Apple is pushing us to lead with the differentiator instead of the swipe deck.

Our IP was never the swiping. It's the conversation design, session flow, memory structure, story generation, and privacy rules. The mission already fits: help people become understood, first by themselves, then by someone else.

Three directions

My draft recommendation is **C, the hybrid**, because it keeps the connection goal and drops the dating-app shape. This is a starting point for discussion, not a final call.

Direction	What it is	Strength	Risk
A. The guide is the product	Multi-session voice conversations with a calm AI guide build your private memory and public story. Introductions come later, and softly.	Deepest differentiation; uses the voice + prosody work	Needs a reason to come back after the story is built
B. Conversation social space	An ad-free, anti-doom-scroll space for introverts, organized around topics and real conversation	Clearly not dating; broad market	Needs community density; moderation load
C. Hybrid	The guide learns who you are, then connects you to people and small conversations around shared topics and values. No swiping, no match percentages.	Both A's depth and B's non-dating framing; romance can stay one intent among several	Largest scope, so V1 has to be cut tight

What carries over, what jumps the line

Most of the backend survives. The voice interview moves from V2 to V1.

Carries over: Supabase backend and auth; block/report RLS hardening; real account deletion, including storage cleanup; hourly report alerting; 1:1 chat; Café rooms; the 18+ gate (client check plus DB constraint).

Jumps the line:

- Move OpenAI token minting to a Supabase Edge Function. `EXPO_PUBLIC_OPENAI_API_KEY` can't ship in a V1 binary.
- Run the voice interview cold runs, and get Kevin's rubric pass on the live demo.
- Build the real InterviewScreen.js and the private-memory vs. public-story data model.
- Decide whether prosody is in V1 or stays in V2.

Apple resubmission angle

The next submission has to read as a different app from top to bottom, since it's under extended review.

- **Category:** move out of Dating, for example to Social Networking or Lifestyle, depending on the direction we pick.
- **Metadata and screenshots:** lead with the guided conversation. Only describe features that are actually in the binary, so we don't repeat the 2.3 miss.
- **Review notes:** a short, plain explanation of what's new and why it isn't a dating app.
- **Timing:** better one strong resubmission than several quick ones while we're flagged. Richard (App Review) asked David to keep his number and call once both apps are resubmitted.

Submission order: PAA first, then Intro, then call Richard. PAA isn't in a saturated category, so it's the cleaner win to land before the Intro pivot goes in.

Decisions for tomorrow

- [ ] Pick a direction: A, B, or C
- [ ] Is romance still the headline, one intent among several, or gone?
- [ ] Keep the Intro name and the "Connect Without Connecting" tagline, or rebrand?
- [ ] Define the V1 scope cut: which of chat, Café, and prosody ship in the first binary
- [ ] Pick a target resubmission window, and decide whether to reach back out to Richard first
- [ ] Who owns what: conversation design and voice (Kevin?) vs. build and backend (David?)